

Process Log: Drawstring Bag

Design

My first idea was a flat case with Velcro, so I can put this cloth case inside my camera bag to hold my camera gears. But then I realized the specific foam that it requires are out of stock, and even though I bought an alternative one, it doesn't work that well. But I was still making the case, the machine broke down, so I cannot continue working on that. And then later, I switched to a simpler idea of a drawstring pouch. I chose this idea because it is more practical with the material I have, and it's simple enough so I can focus on sewing and be better at the details.

Process

- First, I drew a few ideas and compared them.
- Then I picked the drawstring bag idea.
- I cut fabric into the shape I needed.
- I folded the fabric and sewed the side and bottom edges.
- After that, I folded the top edge to make a channel.
- I sewed the top so the string could go through.
- I used a safety pin to pull the string through the channel.
- Then I tested the bag with the scissors inside.
- This helped me see if the size and opening worked well.

Analysis

- The first prototype worked because it helped me test the basic idea.
- It could hold the scissors and close at the top.
- It showed that the drawstring bag idea could work.
- But the first prototype also had problems:
 - The material was too simple.
 - It did not feel durable.
 - The strings were too thin.
 - It did not feel strong enough for long use.
 - It looked weak and not very protective.
- From this, I learned that:
 - The idea was good.

- The materials needed to be stronger.
 - The bag needed more support and better function.
- In my second iteration, I improved the weak parts:
 - I reinforced the bag.
 - I used stronger parts where I could.
 - I added more material to make the bag work better.
 - I added color to make it look better.
 - I used thicker strings so the bag felt stronger.
- In-class critique feedback:
 - The second version looked more finished.
 - It looked stronger and more useful.
 - The bag's purpose was clearer.
- Feedback from someone outside class:
 - They said the second bag looked much sturdier.
 - They thought the first one looked too weak for scissors.
 - They liked that the second one looked more protective and better made.
- What worked:
 - The drawstring idea.
 - The shape of the bag.
 - The stronger second version.
- What did not work:
 - Thin material in the first version.
 - Thin strings.
 - Not enough protection.
- Next steps:
 - I would make the sewing neater.
 - I would maybe add padding inside.
 - I would test other fabrics.
 - If I made another version, I would keep the strong shape but make the finish cleaner.